MODEL LAB · 2026-10-23

Every prior, same slate

The held-out scores that decided which prior is served, then how each one would have ranked today's hitters.

Served (full season)	11	23,148	3.03%	0.6081
served prior	priors compared	held-out plate appearances	held-out HR rate	best AUC · KNN comps

Held-out scores

Fitted on plate appearances before 2026-09-07, scored on the 23,148 that came after (actual HR rate 3.03%). No outcome in the test window was visible during fitting. **Read AUC first** — the slate ranks hitters and takes the top six, so ordering is what matters. Brier and log loss are dominated by the ~3% base rate and barely separate the priors. Metrics are per plate appearance; the probabilities lower down are per game.

PRIOR	AUC	TOP-DECILE LIFT	BRIER	LOG LOSS	CAL. RMSE
Flat league League HR rate as the prior for every hitter.	0.5917	1.68×	0.02934	0.13484	0.00602
KNN comps Prior is the pooled rate of the nearest comparables.	0.6081	1.54×	0.02929	0.13367	0.00460
SVR Support-vector regression on the same feature matrix.	0.6033	1.57×	0.02931	0.13421	0.00492
Random forest Forest regression; a learned similarity metric.	0.6055	1.58×	0.02929	0.13369	0.00375
Core (KNN+SVR) Blend of KNN and SVR, no forest.	0.6081	1.54×	0.02929	0.13367	0.00460
Forest blend KNN + SVR + forest, weights fitted out-of-fold.	0.6081	1.54×	0.02929	0.13367	0.00460
Linear regression Ordinary least squares on the same features.	0.6059	1.57×	0.02930	0.13385	0.00369
Logistic regression Binomial logistic on the per-PA home run outcome.	0.6053	1.57×	0.02932	0.13396	0.00541
Neural net (torch) Two-layer PyTorch MLP, PA-weighted, trained on the same features.	0.6056	1.61×	0.02930	0.13381	0.00385
XGBoost Gradient-boosted trees, depth 3 with subsampling and L2.	0.6036	1.55×	0.02930	0.13393	0.00411

BLEND WEIGHTS (FOREST VARIANT)

KNN **1.00** SVR **0.00** RF **0.00**

SHRINKAGE K PER PRIOR

league **259** knn **259** svr **259** rf **259** core **259** ensemble **259** linear **259** logistic **259** nn **259** xgb **259**

Estimated by method of moments on out-of-fold residuals, not hand-tuned.

Thin-sample subset

The same held-out window, restricted to hitters with fewer than 100 plate appearances before the cutoff (2,370 PA, actual HR rate 2.49%). For a regular with 600 PA the observed record swamps any prior, so the priors mostly separate here.

PRIOR	AUC	TOP-DECILE LIFT	BRIER	LOG LOSS	CAL. RMSE
Flat league League HR rate as the prior for every hitter.	0.5763	1.19×	0.02428	0.11650	0.01359
KNN comps Prior is the pooled rate of the nearest comparables.	0.6166	1.86×	0.02418	0.11439	0.01018
SVR Support-vector regression on the same feature matrix.	0.5967	1.69×	0.02433	0.11860	0.01890
Random forest Forest regression; a learned similarity metric.	0.6122	1.69×	0.02423	0.11481	0.01426
Core (KNN+SVR) Blend of KNN and SVR, no forest.	0.6166	1.86×	0.02418	0.11439	0.01018
Forest blend KNN + SVR + forest, weights fitted out-of-fold.	0.6166	1.86×	0.02418	0.11439	0.01018
Linear regression Ordinary least squares on the same features.	0.6137	1.69×	0.02425	0.11594	0.01351
Logistic regression Binomial logistic on the per-PA home run outcome.	0.6211	1.69×	0.02429	0.11568	0.01283
Neural net (torch) Two-layer PyTorch MLP, PA-weighted, trained on the same features.	0.6118	2.03×	0.02421	0.11509	0.01040
XGBoost Gradient-boosted trees, depth 3 with subsampling and L2.	0.5986	1.53×	0.02431	0.11614	0.01566

Slate agreement

PRIOR	SHARED	ITS TOP SIX
Served (full season)	6/6	Jackson Chourio 16.5%, Junior Caminero 15.9%, Jake Bauers 15.6%, William Contreras 15.2%, Jonathan Aranda 14.6%, Brice Turang 13.8%
Flat league	6/6	Jackson Chourio 16.7%, Junior Caminero 15.2%, William Contreras 15.1%, Jake Bauers 14.7%, Brice Turang 14.1%, Jonathan Aranda 14.0%
KNN comps	6/6	Jackson Chourio 16.6%, Jake Bauers 15.8%, Junior Caminero 15.7%, William Contreras 15.2%, Jonathan Aranda 14.8%, Brice Turang 13.7%
SVR	6/6	Jackson Chourio 17.3%, Junior Caminero 17.0%, Jake Bauers 16.0%, William Contreras 15.2%, Jonathan Aranda 14.5%, Brice Turang 13.6%
Random forest	6/6	Jackson Chourio 17.2%, Jake Bauers 16.2%, Junior Caminero 16.1%, William Contreras 15.3%, Jonathan Aranda 14.5%, Brice Turang 13.6%
Core (KNN+SVR)	6/6	Jackson Chourio 16.6%, Jake Bauers 15.8%, Junior Caminero 15.7%, William Contreras 15.2%, Jonathan Aranda 14.8%, Brice Turang 13.7%
Forest blend	6/6	Jackson Chourio 16.6%, Jake Bauers 15.8%, Junior Caminero 15.7%, William Contreras 15.2%, Jonathan Aranda 14.8%, Brice Turang 13.7%
Linear regression	6/6	Jackson Chourio 17.2%, Junior Caminero 15.9%, Jake Bauers 15.7%, William Contreras 15.2%, Jonathan Aranda 14.7%, Brice Turang 13.1%
Logistic regression	6/6	Jackson Chourio 17.2%, Junior Caminero 16.3%, Jake Bauers 15.7%, William Contreras 15.2%, Jonathan Aranda 14.4%, Brice Turang 13.0%
Neural net (torch)	6/6	Jackson Chourio 17.2%, Junior Caminero 16.3%, Jake Bauers 15.9%, William Contreras 15.2%, Jonathan Aranda 14.5%, Brice Turang 13.1%
XGBoost	6/6	Jackson Chourio 17.3%, Junior Caminero 16.6%, Jake Bauers 16.3%, William Contreras 15.5%, Jonathan Aranda 14.6%, Brice Turang 13.2%

Hitter by hitter

The top 40 bats by the served probability.

	HITTER		SERVED (FULL SEASON)	FLAT LEAGUE	KNN COMPS	SVR	RANDOM FOREST	CORE (KNN+SVR)	FOREST BLEND	LINEAR REGRESSION	LOGISTIC REGRESSION	NEURAL NET (TO
1	**Jackson Chourio**	MIL	**16.5%**	16.7%	16.6%	17.3%	17.2%	16.6%	16.6%	17.2%	17.2%	
2	**Junior Caminero**	TB	**15.9%**	15.2%	15.7%	17.0%	16.1%	15.7%	15.7%	15.9%	16.3%	
3	**Jake Bauers**	MIL	**15.6%**	14.7%	15.8%	16.0%	16.2%	15.8%	15.8%	15.7%	15.7%	
4	**William Contreras**	MIL	**15.2%**	15.1%	15.2%	15.2%	15.3%	15.2%	15.2%	15.2%	15.2%	
5	**Jonathan Aranda**	TB	**14.6%**	14.0%	14.8%	14.5%	14.5%	14.8%	14.8%	14.7%	14.4%	
6	**Brice Turang**	MIL	**13.8%**	14.1%	13.7%	13.6%	13.6%	13.7%	13.7%	13.1%	13.0%	
7	**Garrett Mitchell**	MIL	**13.2%**	12.7%	12.9%	11.9%	12.7%	12.9%	12.9%	12.7%	12.6%	
8	**Christian Yelich**	MIL	**12.6%**	12.8%	13.1%	12.4%	12.9%	13.1%	13.1%	13.1%	12.5%	
9	**Yandy Díaz**	TB	**12.5%**	12.8%	12.5%	13.0%	12.8%	12.5%	12.5%	12.7%	12.6%	
10	**Victor Mesa Jr.**	TB	**12.1%**	11.9%	12.1%	12.6%	12.5%	12.1%	12.1%	12.4%	12.3%	
11	**Liam Hicks**	TB	**7.9%**	9.3%	7.9%	8.8%	8.2%	7.9%	7.9%	8.5%	8.3%	
12	**Jonny DeLuca**	TB	**7.2%**	7.8%	7.1%	7.1%	6.6%	7.1%	7.1%	7.1%	7.3%	
13	**Richie Palacios**	TB	**7.1%**	7.8%	7.0%	6.7%	6.3%	7.0%	7.0%	6.8%	6.8%	
14	**Joey Ortiz**	MIL	**6.9%**	8.3%	7.3%	7.5%	7.5%	7.3%	7.3%	7.3%	7.3%	
15	**Sal Frelick**	MIL	**6.8%**	8.6%	6.9%	6.4%	6.4%	6.9%	6.9%	6.6%	6.7%	
16	**Cooper Pratt**	MIL	**6.5%**	8.4%	6.6%	5.7%	6.1%	6.6%	6.6%	5.7%	5.9%	
17	**Taylor Walls**	TB	**4.7%**	6.5%	4.8%	3.9%	3.9%	4.8%	4.8%	4.9%	4.8%	
18	**Chandler Simpson**	TB	**2.9%**	6.2%	3.6%	1.6%	1.7%	3.6%	3.6%	1.6%	3.3%	

Per-game probabilities: each prior's per-PA rate run through this hitter's own plate appearances, park, weather, bullpen and times-through-the-order terms. Only the prior changes across the columns — every other term is held fixed, so a left-to-right spread is the prior disagreeing about the hitter, not the context. Shading grows with the probability.

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